

ESSENTIAL

Document Checklist by Applicant Type

Sperrkonto - Sponsor-funded - Scholarship - Studienkolleg route

Every applicant needs

- Your Zulassungsbescheid from a German university, or Studienkolleg admission
- Valid passport
- Evidence of language ability meeting your programme's requirement
- A Sperrkonto confirmation or an accepted alternative financial mechanism (see the Financial Requirements Overview)
- Health insurance confirmation (GKV or private, as applicable)

If your nationality requires APS certification

- Your APS certificate, obtained before applying - check whether this applies to you well in advance, since the process itself takes time

If a parent or relative is funding you instead of a Sperrkonto

- A formal declaration of commitment from a sponsor resident in Germany (a Verpflichtungserklärung), if that route applies in your case, or their financial evidence plus a supporting letter
- See the Sponsor & Financial Letter Templates (Complete tier)

If you're sponsored by a scholarship (e.g. DAAD or a similar body)

- An official confirmation letter from the sponsoring body, which can substitute for a Sperrkonto for the amount and duration it covers

If you're completing a Studienkolleg year first

- Your conditional university admission, contingent on completing the Studienkolleg
- Your Studienkolleg enrolment confirmation

After you arrive

DON'T SKIP THE RESIDENCE PERMIT STEP

Register your address (Anmeldung) and apply for your residence permit (Aufenthaltserlaubnis) at your local Ausländerbehörde within your visa's validity window - this is a separate, mandatory step, not something that happens automatically.